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MABRAY JOYCE A
83 COLOMBO 462

28/26/85 082943

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PAGE 01 COLOMB 00462 230655Z

ACTION OES-09

INFO OCT-00 COPY-01 ADS-00 INR-10 EUR-01 SS-10 CIAE-00
NFA-06 NSCE-00 NSAE-00 NASA-01 SSO-00 L-03 DOE-10
PM-09 PA-01 FEMA-02 INRE-00 ANAF-02 DOEE-00 /263 W
-----206550 230701Z /11

O 230600Z JAN 83

FM AMEMBASSY COLOMBO

TO SECSTATE WASHDC NIACT IMMEDIATE 7772

USIA WASHDC NIACT IMMEDIATE 1033

INFO AMEMBASSY NEW DELHI IMMEDIATE

AMCONSUL MADRAS IMMEDIATE

CINCPAC HONOLULU HI IMMEDIATE

SECDEF WASHDC IMMEDIATE

DIA WASHDCINGTON DC IMMEDIATE

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USIA FOR VOA

E.O. 12356: N/A

TAGS: TSPA, MNUC, CZ, UR

SUBJECT: GSL REPORTS EVIDENCE THAT "SOMETHING HAS FALLEN " FROM
SPACE IN KURUNEGALA

REFS: (A) HORKEY-HAGERTY TELCOM 22 JAN 83

(B) HORKEY-MALINOWSKI TELCOM 22 JAN 83

1. CONFIRMING EARLIER TELECONS TO OPCENTER. FOREIGN SECRETARY

W.T. JAYESINGHE TELEPHONE EMBASSY LATE SATUR-

DAY AFTERNOON 22 JANUARY AND SPOKE WITH EMBOFF MALINOWSKI WHO

HAPPENED TO BE IN THE OFFICE. FONSEC REPORTED THAT SOMETHING HAS

BEEN REPORTED TO HAVE HIT THE GROUND IN THE KURUNEGALA AREA (42

MILES NORTH AND EAST OF COLOMBO) AND THAT A GSL SCIENTIFIC TEAM

HEADED BY DR. GRANVILLE DHARMAWARDENA, CHAIRMAN OF THE ATOMIC

ENERGY AUTHORITY, HAD BEEN DISPATCHED TO THE AREA WITH A GEIGER

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COUNTER TO CHECK THE AREA OF THE REPORTED IMPACT FOR SIGNS OF
RADIATION AND ANY FRAGMENTS.

2. SRI LANKAN RADIO REPORTED SHORTLY AFTERWARDS THAT SOMETHING FROM

OUTER SPACE HAD STRUCK IN THE KURUNEGALA AREA AND QUOTED ARTHUR
C. CLARKE, AUTHOR OF "2001" AND "2010" WHO IS RESIDENT IN SRI LANKA,
AS SUGGESTING LONG ODDS ON METEORITE.

3. EMBOFF TELEPHONED OPCENTER IN DEPARTMENT TO RELAY REPORT AND
WAS TOLD THERE IS NO EVIDENCE YET THAT COSMOS 1402 SATELLITE REPORTED
TO BE DECAYING HAS MADE ITS FINAL PLUNGE TO EARTH. EMBOFF REPORTED
THIS TO FONSEC BY PHONE, AND FONSEC SAID HE WOULD AWAIT REPORT OF
SCIENTIST BEFORE RENDERING ANY FURTHER JUDGEMENTS.

4. AT ABOUT 2000 LOCAL TIME, FONSEC TELEPHONED DCM AT HOME TO
REPORT ON CONVERSATION, PRESUMABLY ALSO BY PHONE, WITH SCIENTISTS
INVESTIGATING THE INCIDENT. INITIAL REPORT, HE SAID HAD BEEN MADE BY
TWO BOYS WHO REPORTED TO POLICE HAVING SEEN "SOMETHING LIKE A
FLAMING TENNIS BALL DESCENDING AND STRIKING THE EARTH. POLICE

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REVIEWED BY R. Long DATE 7/8/86

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TS AUTH. _____ REASON(S) _____

ENDORSE EXISTING MARKINGS ☐

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RELAYED REPORT TO COLOMBO RESULTING IN DESPATCH OF SCIENTIST;
PRECISE TIME OF SIGHTING IS NOT KNOWN.

5. SCIENTIST REPORTED TO FONSEC THAT WHEN HE ARRIVED AT THE SCENE THERE WAS "SOME EVIDENCE OF SOME SORT OF IMPACT" BUT THERE WAS NO OBJECT IN EVIDENCE. SCIENTIST CONCLUDED THAT "SOMETHING HAS FALLEN," BUT THAT WHATEVER IT WAS DISINTEGRATED ON IMPACT. A CHECK OF THE AREA WITH THE GEIGER COUNTER REVEALED THAT IN A ZONE ABOUT 2 SQUARE YARDS AROUND THE "IMPACT" SITE THERE WAS A EVIDENCE OF "VERY MILD RADIO-ACTIVITY" BUT AT A VERY LOW LEVEL, I.E. "NOT HARMFUL TO LIVING MATTER." THE SCIENTIFIC TEAM LOOKED OVER THE AREA CAREFULLY AND THEN SCOOPED UP SOME OF THE RADIO-ACTIVE SOIL IN A CONTAINER FOR SHIPMENT TO COLOMBO, WHERE IT WILL BE EXAMINED IN GREATER DETAIL

IN THE MORNING (I.E. 23 JANUARY).

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6. DCM ASKED FONSEC IF HE HAD REPORTED ALL OF THIS TO THE SOVIET EMBASSY; FONSEC SAID YES AND THAT SOVIETS DENY IT IS THEIRS. DCM ASKED IF GSL WAS REQUESTING ANYTHING OF THE USG AT THIS POINT. FONSEC SAID NO; HIS PURPOSE, HE SAID, WAS TO INFORM US OF THE DEVELOPMENT FOR OUR INFORMATION. HE EXPRESSED APPRECIATION FOR OUR REGULAR REPORTS TO THE GSL ON THE COSMOS MATTER AND SAID HE EXPECTED NO FURTHER DEVELOPMENTS ON THIS INCIDENT UNTIL MORNING WHEN THE SCIENTISTS HAVE ANOTHER LOOK AT THE SOIL SAMPLE IN COLOMBO. FOR HIMSELF, HE SAID, HE WAS GOING HOME TO HAVE HIS DINNER.

7. DCM REPLAYED INFO IN PARAGRAPHS 4-6 TO OPCENTER BY PHONE AT 2740 LOCAL TIME, AND HE PROMISED FURTHER WRAP-UP--IF ANY ADDITIONAL DETAILS ARE AVAILABLE--IN MORNING.

8. ON MORNING OF 23 JANUARY, DR. DHARMAWARDENE, WHO HAD RETURNED TO COLOMBO FROM KURUNEGALA WITH SOIL SAMPLES FROM THE IMPACT AREA, INFORMED DATT AND EMROFF THAT AN UNKNOWN OBJECT HAD LANDED IN THE VICINITY OF THE TOWN OF MAWATAGAMA IN THE KURUNEGALA DISTRICT (07-25N/080-26E) AT 1230 HOURS 22 JANUARY (227022Z JAN 83). HE DESCRIBED THE IMPACT AREA AS BEING A BURNED AND INDENTED PATCH ABOUT 2 AND ONE HALF INCHES IN RADIUS. DHARMAWARDENE HAS BROUGHT ABOUT TEN KILOS OF SOIL, REPRESENTING ABOUT TWO SQUARE YARDS OF THE IMPACT AREA, BACK TO COLOMBO FOR ANALYSIS. HE RECONFIRMED THAT THE SITE AREA WAS SLIGHTLY RADIOACTIVE. HE ALSO INDICATED THAT NO METALLIC DEBRIS WAS FOUND AT THE SITE AREA AND THAT HE DID NOT BELIEVE THAT THE OBJECT WAS ASSOCIATED WITH COSMOS 1402.

9. DR. DHARMAWARDENE WOULD APPRECIATE ANY INFORMATION USG CAN PROVIDE ON OBJECT THAT FELL IN KURUNEGALA. NEED

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83 COLOMBO 525

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PAGE 01 COLOMB 00525 251202Z

ACTION OES-39

INFO OCT-00 COPY-01 ADS-00 INR-10 SS-12 CIAE-20 NEA-05
NSCE-30 NSAE-00 NASA-01 L-03 DOE-10 PM-39 PA-01
FEMA-02 DOE-02 /062 W

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P R 251100Z JAN 83
FM AMEMBASSY COLOMBO
TO SECSTATE WASHDC PRIORITY 7802
USIA WASHDC PRIORITY 1042
INFO AMEMBASSY MOSCOW PRIORITY
DIA WASHDC PRIORITY
CINCPAC HONOLULU HI PRIORITY
AMEMBASSY NEW DELHI
C O N F I D E N T I A L COLOMBO 0525
USIA FOR VOA
F.O. 12356: DECL/ OADR
TAGS: TSPA, MNUC, CE, UR
SUBJ: (U) SRI LANKAN UNIDENTIFIED SPACE OBJECT
RFF: COLOMBO 0462 (NOTAL)

DEPARTMENT OF STATE A/CDC/MR

REVIEWED BY RAL DATE 7/8/8
RDS ☐ or XDS ☐ EXT. DATE _____
TS AUTH. _____ REASON(S) _____
ENDORSE EXISTING MARKINGS ☐
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1. (C) ENTIRE TEXT.
2. ACCORDING TO A MFA CONTACT, THE PRELIMINARY ANALYSIS OF THE RESIDUE OF THE UNKNOWN OBJECT THAT STRUCK THE GROUND IN THE YURUNEJALA AREA OF SRI LANKA ON 22 JANUARY REVEALS THE PRESENCE OF THE FOLLOWING SUBSTANCES: 1.3 PERCENT ALUMINUM, 3.0 PERCENT IRON, 10 TO 15 PERCENT BARIUM, AND SMALL TRACES OF SULFUR, MAGNESIUM, AND TITANIUM. THE RESIDUE HAS BEEN SENT TO A GOVERNMENT ANALYST WHOSE REPORT IS EXPECTED IN 2 OR 3 DAYS.
3. THE GSL HAS NOT RPT NOT DETERMINED WHETHER THE OBJECT

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PAGE 02 COLOMB 00525 251202Z
WAS PART OF COSMOS 1402. WHILE THE GSL HAS INFORMATION ABOUT THE NORMAL COMPOSITION OF USS SATELLITES, IT DOES NOT HAVE COMPARABLE INFORMATION ABOUT SOVIET ONES AND DOES NOT EXPECT TO RECEIVE ANY FROM THE SOVIETS. BASED ON RESULTS OF THE PRELIMINARY ANALYSIS, THE GSL DOES NOT THINK THAT THE OBJECT WAS A METEORITE. THE GSL HAS ALSO NOT DISCOUNTED

THE POSSIBILITY THAT THE INCIDENT WAS A HOAX OR THAT THE OBJECT MIGHT HAVE BEEN A FIREWORK. THERE IS GROWING PUBLIC SPECULATION THAT IT WAS, IN FACT, A PIECE OF COSMOS 1402.

4. HOWEVER, SRI LANKAN RESIDENT ARTHUR C. CLARKE, WHO HAS BEEN ASSISTING THE INVESTIG, BELIEVES THE OBJECT WAS NOT A METEORITE AND THAT THERE IS NO CONFIRMING EVIDENCE THAT IT CAME FROM OUTER SPACE.
5. THE INCIDENT CONTINUES TO RECEIVE EXTENSIVE COVERAGE IN SRI LANKAN MEDIA.

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83 COLOMBO 613

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PAGE 01 COLOMB 00613 311205Z

ACTION OES-09

INFO OCT-80 COPY-01 ADS-00 INR-10 EUR-01 SS-10 CIAE-00
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P 311200Z JAN 93

J AMEMBASSY COLOMBO

TO SECSTATE WASHDC PRIORITY 7851

USIA WASHDC PRIORITY 1052

INFO DIA WASHDC PRIORITY

CINCPAC HONOLULU HI PRIORITY

AMEMBASSY MOSCOW PRIORITY

UNCLAS COLOMBO 0613

E.O. 12356: N/A

TAGS: TSPA MNUC CE UR

SUBJ: SRI LANKAN SPACE OBJECT

REF: COLOMBO 0525

ACCORDING TO A REPORT IN THE 31 JANUARY "EVENING OBSERVER",
CHAIRMAN OF THE SRI LANKAN ATOMIC ENERGY AUTHORITY, GRANVILLE
DHARMAWARDENE, HAS SAID THAT THE FLAMING OBJECT WHICH FELL IN THE
KURUNEGALA AREA ON 22 JANUARY WAS A METEORITE. HE CATEGORICALLY
DENIED THAT IT WAS RADIOACTIVE OR A PIECE OF COSMOS 1402.

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SMITH VELMA T
63 COLOMBO 645

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PAGE 01 COLOMB 00645 020252Z

ACTION OES-09

INFO OCT-20 COPY-01 ADS-00 INR-10 EUR-01 SF-10 CIAE-20
NEA-07 NSC-01 NSAF-00 NASA-02 L-03 DOE-10 PM-09
FEMA-02 ACDA-12 /077 W

230456 020337 /82

P 011240Z FEB 83
FM AMEMBASSY COLOMBO
TO SECSTATE WASHDC PRIORITY 7869
USIA WASHDC PRIORITY 1060
INFO DIA WASHDC PRIORITY
CINCPAC HONOLULU HI PRIORITY
AMEMBASSY MOSCOW
UNCLAS COLOMBO 0645
F.O. 12356: N/A
TAGS: TSPA MNUC CE UR
SUBJ: (U) UNIDENTIFIED SPACE OBJECT (U.S.O.): OOPS! IT WAS
A FLARE

DEPARTMENT OF STATE A/CDC/MR

REVIEWED BY OPH DATE 7/8/86

RDS ☐ or IDS ☐ EXT. DATE

TS AUTH. REASON(S)

ENDORSE EXISTING MARKINGS ☐

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REF: COLOMBO 0613

1. REPORTS IN 1 FEBRUARY SRI LANKAN PRESS INDICATE THAT THE ARTICLE
UPON WHICH WE BASED REPTTEL WAS INACCURATE. SRI LANKAN ATOMIC
ENERGY AUTHORITY INVESTIGATING TEAM HAS NOW DETERMINED THAT THE
OBJECT WAS A "FLARE," OR POSSIBLY FIREWORKS.
2. ACCORDING TO THE REPORT, INVESTIGATING TEAM BASED ITS FINAL
CONCLUSIONS ON FOUR GROUNDS. BECAUSE THERE WAS NO DENT ON THE
GROUND WHERE THE OBJECT FELL, TEAM DOUBTED WHETHER IT WAS A FAST
MOVING, HEAVY OBJECT SUCH AS PART OF A SATELLITE OR A METEORITE.
IT HAD BEEN CONCLUSIVELY PROVED, HOWEVER, THAT WHAT FELL WAS A
HOT OBJECT WHICH BURNT ITSELF OUT. PRESENCE OF RADIOACTIVITY AT THE
LANDING POINT WAS EVENTUALLY DISCOUNTED, SINCE IT WAS ONLY MILDLY
ABOVE BACKGROUND LEVEL IN THE AREA. FINALLY, WHITE LUMPS FOUND
AT THE LANDING POINT SHOWED THE PRESENCE OF SMALL QUANTITIES OF

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MAGNESIUM, ALUMINUM, AND IRON, WITH HIGH PERCENTAGES OF BARIUM,
AND TRACE ELEMENTS OF MANGANESE, TITANIUM, ZIRCONIUM, YTRIUM.

TEAM ALSO FOUND POTASSIUM NITRATE AND CHLORIDE, RESIDUES OF
EXPLODED DEVICES USED IN FIREWORKS.

3. WE CONSIDER THE U.S.O. INCIDENT CLOSED.

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